GAME AUDIO

JOB PLACEMENT GUIDE

Leon Seb | 07/2025 - 4° ed.

www.soundoflion.com

CONTENTS

01 Introduction .03

02 Experience Levels .04

03 Roles .05

04 Work Types, Contracts & Projects .06

05 Resume .07

06 Cover Letter .12

07 Demo Reel .14

08 Job Interviews .15

09 Netwroking .17

10 Inclusive job placement .18

11 Freelance Work Strategies .19

12 Resources .20

13 About the author .21

01 INTRODUCTION

Disclaimer: This document is dynamic and may require updates in the short term. All information has been compiled from personal experiences, interviews with industry professionals, and documentation from recruiters and specialized platforms.

This guide does not guarantee job placement or define specific timelines. Its purpose is to provide tools, guidance, and an understanding of the job market in game audio.

About the guide

This document gathers information about roles related to the field of audio within the video game industry. Everything presented here should be adapted to your knowledge, interests, and needs when entering the job market.

Before continuing, I recommend identifying your priorities and goals. This will help you better filter the information and tailor it to your situation. What works for you today might change tomorrow.

Here's a template to help you reflect on your ideal job profile. You don't need to have everything figured out right now — the guide will explore each point in more detail:

Job Profile Definition

- Level and Role: _____
  Example: Senior Sound Designer
- Type of Employment: _____
  Example: Freelance / Full-time
- Work Modality: _____
  Example: Hybrid / Remote / On-site
- Desired Salary: _____
  Example: USD$ xx.xxx Annually / Range
- Project Type: _____
  Example: Adventure / Horror

02 EXPERIENCE LEVELS

EXPERIENCE LEVELS

Within the video game industry, positions related to the audio field can generally be grouped into the following hierarchical levels:

Entry-Level
Initial positions such as **Trainee**, **Junior**, or **Associate**. These roles typically require between 0 and 2 years of experience. They often work under direct supervision and are in a stage of professional development. The term **Associate** may vary depending on the studio — some use it as an entry-level title, while others place it in an intermediate tier.

Mid-Level
Roles such as **Mid** or **Semi-Senior**, generally with 2 to 5 years of experience. A certain level of autonomy is expected, along with problem-solving abilities and clear communication within the team.

Senior-Level
Professionals with 5 or more years of experience who can lead complex tasks, make technical decisions, and mentor junior team members. While they may not hold formal leadership titles, they typically serve as internal reference points.

Leadership
This includes roles such as **Lead** or **Principal**. These professionals either manage the audio team (**Lead**) or specialize deeply in specific technical areas (**Principal**). These positions involve people management, planning, mentoring, and strategic decision-making within the audio department.

Direction
Includes roles like **Head of Audio** or **Audio Director**. These professionals oversee the entire audio department, define the creative and technical vision, and collaborate with other studio leadership roles. Their responsibilities range from the final audio quality to team culture and resource planning.

Important
Each studio defines its own structure. Not all levels are always present — especially in smaller or indie studios. What matters most is identifying the level that best matches your profile and the context of the job opportunity.

03 ROLES

ROLES

In video game development, audio-related roles can be grouped into several areas of specialization. Below are some of the most common ones:

Music Roles

- Composer (linear music)
- Music Designer (composition from an interactive perspective)
- Music Supervisor (especially in rhythm games or music licensing contexts)

Sound Design

- Sound Designer
- VO Sound Designer (voice design, dialogue editing, vocal processing)

Implementation

- Technical Sound Designer
- Technical Music Designer
- Audio Programmer

General or Mixed Roles

- Audio Engineer / Sound Engineer
- Audio Producer
- Audio QA Specialist (bug testing and audio integration quality assurance)
- Audio Editor (post-production, cleanup, asset editing)

Leadership roles such as Lead Sound Designer or Audio Director are typically built upon experience in one or more of the roles listed above. For example, an Audio Director often starts as a Sound Designer, Technical Sound Designer, or even Composer.
Those with a technical background — focused on implementation or programming — often evolve into technical leadership or middleware/systems management roles.

Tip

Pay close attention to the job description. Role names can vary widely between studios and may not always reflect the exact responsibilities. If something isn't clear, don't hesitate to ask the recruiter or technical team. It's always better to ask than to assume.

04 WORK TYPES, CONTRACTS & PROJECTS

WORK MODALITY

The most common work modalities in the industry are **on-site**, **hybrid** (a combination of remote and on-site), and **remote**. In some cases, companies offer international relocation packages, which may include:

- Flights and visa assistance.
- Housing for 1 to 3 months.
- Financial support for food and transportation during the first months.
- Support for spouse or children, if applicable.

CONTRACT TYPES

Contract types vary depending on the project and the studio.
It's important to understand the terms before accepting any offer, as each modality comes with different rights, responsibilities, and payment structures.

Freelance
This is a client–service provider relationship. Payment is usually made per project, task, or asset delivery.
There is no formal employment relationship. The timeline and workflow are managed by the contractor, unless otherwise agreed.

Contractor (Fixed Term Contract)
Temporary employment under specific pre-agreed conditions.
This typically involves a signed contract outlining duration, tasks, schedule, and payment. Terms may be negotiated or directly proposed by the employer.
Common in medium to large studios.

Part-Time / Full-Time
Both involve a formal employment relationship, either temporary or permanent. Part-time typically involves 4 to 6 working hours per day, while full-time usually includes 7 to 9 hours per day.
These modalities often include benefits like paid vacation, sick leave, and tax obligations, depending on the country and contract type.

PROJECT

Working conditions vary depending on the studio, budget, and project.
In small teams, it's common to take on additional tasks without extra pay.
Always clarify responsibilities before signing.

05 RESUME

Your Resume or Curriculum Vitae (CV) should ideally be one-page long and include all relevant information for the position — such as skills (both technical and soft), tools, languages, experience, and education.
The content should be well-organized and easy to read. Visual presentation also matters: a clean, balanced design can make a big difference.
Below is an example of a traditional CV format.

TRADITIONAL FORMAT

Dyijon Golf
Sound Designer

BA, Argentina | +54113x5x78x7 | golfdyijon@xmail.com
Portfolio | Web

Experience

Imsoñiac LTD
Sound Designer | Oct 2019 - Ofiuco 2024

- Desgined a full kit of sound that enhance the game
- Implementation using WKnowledge into RealEngine 4

Shipped games: Coquito in the Beach (2021)
Achivements: I'm very good designer

Imsoñiac LTD
Sound Designer | Oct 2019 - Ofiuco 2024

- Desgined a full kit of sound that enhance the game
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- Desgined a full kit of sound that enhance the game
- Implementation using WKnowledge into RealEngine 4

Shipped games: Coquito in the Beach (2021)
Achivements: I'm very good designer

Independient Releases

Title Game
Sound Designer | Oct 2019 - Ofiuco 2024

Title Game
Sound Designer | Oct 2019 - Ofiuco 2024

Title Game
Sound Designer | Oct 2019 - Ofiuco 2024

Title Game
Sound Designer | Oct 2019 - Ofiuco 2024

Languages
Spanish (Native)
English (Super)
Portuguese (X)

Softwares
Reaper, Ableton Live
Fcloth,WKnowledge
RealEngine 4, Disunity
iProton RX

Education
Audio Videogames (2017)
UTÑ - Argentina

Marketing (2017)
UTÑ - Argentina

Skills
Dialogue Editing
Recording
Memes creation

Soft Skills
Super collaborative
Super fun
Audioooo

Awards
Super Sound Designer - AVAx (203x)

Certifications
Super Sound Designer 101
SoftwareX

05 RESUME

You can also choose a more visual or stylized CV format, as long as it maintains clarity and a logical information structure.
Pick a template that represents your style — but always prioritize readability.
Make sure the design doesn't compromise functionality.
Below is an example of a stylized CV layout.

STYLIZED FORMAT

DYIJON GOLF

SOUND DESIGNER

+54 11 x3x5 x7x8x

golfdyijon@xmail.com

BA, Argentina

ABOUT

Very good at everything, very nice person. I can make hotcakes and mates. Also, I love animals, bikes and icecream. not more than this, because its too much

PORTFOLIO

• EDUCACIÓN

Amazing
University, 2016

Amazing
University, 2016

• SOFTWARES

audio
reaper, etc etc etc
engines
RealEngine 4, etc etc etc

• SKILLS

recording, mixing
dialogue
dialogue

• LANGUAGES

Spanglish
super cool and legit.

• EXPERIENCIE

Insomñiac LTD
Sound Designer, Ene 2016 - Ofiuco 2017
• Designed a bunch of cool sounds.
• Implemented using Fwod and Disunity
Shipped games: AudioRol (2038)
Achivements: Mate Tuesday

Insomñiac LTD
Sound Designer, Ene 2016 - Ofiuco 2017
• Designed a bunch of cool sounds.
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Sound Designer, Ene 2016 - Ofiuco 2017
• Designed a bunch of cool sounds.
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Shipped games: AudioRol (2038)
Achivements: Mate Tuesday

• COLLABS

Music with a bunch of people
Title, year
• music music
• audio audio

Music with a bunch of people
Title, year
• music music

05 RESUME

GENERAL RECOMMENDATIONS

1. There is no such thing as a perfect CV. Use templates that suit your profile, but always prioritize a clear and well-organized layout.

2. Include only experience relevant to the position. If you don't have formal experience, add freelance projects, collaborations, or game jams.

3. Be brief and direct in your descriptions. Use bullet points and avoid redundancy. Three points per job are usually enough.

4. If you use columns, it's better to have just one — divided into clear sections like: skills, software, soft skills, etc.

5. If you have a portfolio or website, include active links or hyperlink buttons. Avoid QR codes.

6. Sections like "About me" or a personal photo are optional. Some recruiters appreciate them, while others find them unnecessary.

7. Submit your CV as a PDF or DOC file, ideally under 5 MB. There are websites that help reduce the file size of a PDF.

8. Protect your personal information. Including your city, email, and phone number is usually enough. Avoid sharing your exact address, ID number, or marital status unless it's strictly required for a local application.

05 RESUME

SECTIONS

About / Summary
This section is optional but useful to briefly introduce yourself. In one or two sentences, you can mention your interests, career goals, or what motivates you about working in the audio field.
Avoid vague phrases like “I’m passionate” or “high-level professional.” Instead, focus on what you do, how you do it, and the value you bring.

Experience
List your experience starting from the most recent. Prioritize what’s relevant to the role you’re applying for, and avoid adding unrelated jobs.

For each experience, you can include a short description or use bullet points to summarize tasks, achievements, or concrete results. For example:

- Designed and edited sound effects for AAA cinematics, with a focus on games and interactivity.
- Implemented audio systems in Unity and Wwise for music and combat across multiple characters.

You can also include measurable achievements. Example: “Increased social media engagement by 30% through audio branding campaigns.”

If you don’t have formal experience but participated in collaborative projects, jams, or unpaid roles, include them too — ideally with a link to a demo if possible.

Formal Education
Include degrees or programs relevant to the position. If you have studies unrelated to audio, you may omit or briefly mention them.

Specializations
You can include short courses, workshops, or training — even without official certification. What matters is that they’re clearly labeled and, if possible, include the institution and year.

05 RESUME

SECTIONS

Skills, Soft Skills & Software
You can separate technical skills from soft skills.

- **Technical**: mixing, post-production, implementation, voice editing, scripting, etc.
- **Soft Skills**: problem-solving, attention to detail, teamwork, communication, among others.

You can also include a dedicated section for tools or software (DAWs, middleware, game engines, etc.).

Languages
List the languages you speak and your general level (basic, intermediate, advanced, or native).
It's not necessary to specify speaking/writing/reading unless the position requires it.

Contact Information
Include only essential details: city of residence, email, and phone number.
Avoid including your exact address, ID number, or marital status — unless required for a specific local application.

Portfolio & Links
If you have a portfolio, demo reel, LinkedIn profile, or personal website, include them as active links or buttons.

References
If you choose to include references, make sure they are people you've worked with directly.
It's recommended to include their full name, role, project/company you worked on together, and a contact method (email or LinkedIn).

Example:
Laura Gómez – Sound Supervisor | Project: "Ecos del Norte" (2023) | laura.gomez@email.com

Always get the person's consent before sharing their information.

06 COVER LETTER

The cover letter is a short document that introduces your profile and explains why you're applying for a specific position. It's a great opportunity to show your interest and connect your experience to the studio's vision.
It's not always required — but when it is, it can make a big difference. Here are some tips for writing one:

EXAMPLE

DYIJON GOLF
SOUND DESIGNER

+54 11 x3x5 x7x8x
golfdyijon@xmail.com
BA, Argentina

DEAR INSOMLIAC LTD,

I'm Dyijon, a passionate gamer and sound designer, and I'm thrilled to apply for your role.

First off, let me say that your job posting is absolutely incredible, just like me. I've climbed the tallest mountains, dived into the deepest oceans, and even sprinted the longest mile, all to realize that sound is just another fantastic component of the world. Mind-blowing, isn't it? Consider me your plot twist expert!

Your company's values really resonate with me. I'm passionate about so many things, especially when it comes to talking about audio, games, and why Reaper is the absolute best DAW. Trust me, I can go on and on for hours! Need more proof? Check out my webpage, where I've dedicated a whole column to showcasing my audio obsession.

But wait, there's more! Not only will I immerse myself in gaming for countless hours, but I'll also take it to the next level. Picture this: me, serving mate tea to every soul in the office, channeling the power of caffeine and camaraderie. It's a win-win situation—endless gaming sessions and a constant supply of refreshing mate to keep us fueled and ready to conquer virtual worlds.

I can't wait to bring my enthusiasm and expertise to your team. Let's create some epic soundscapes together!

Kisses, bye-bye.

YOUR FRIENDLY SAUCE,
DYIJON

06 COVER LETTER

GENERAL RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Before writing it, carefully read the job posting and adapt the letter to the company's values, projects, and requirements.

2. The tone can be formal or casual, depending on the company's profile. What matters is that it's professional, clear, and authentic.

3. The letter should summarize your relevant experience, why you're interested in the position, and what motivates you about the project. Avoid repeating your CV and focus on showing your personal interest.

4. Ideally, it should be no more than three paragraphs of about four lines each. The reading should be agile, with good structure and coherence.

5. Use the same layout or visual style as your CV. Include your contact details and, if possible, hyperlinks to your portfolio or demo reel.

6. Read the letter out loud before sending it. This will help you check tone, clarity, and spot errors more naturally.

7. It's recommended to send the file in PDF or DOC format, with a size under 5 MB.

8. If the application platform requires writing it in a form, adapt the text to three paragraphs and keep only the essentials.

07 DEMO REEL

The demo reel is an audiovisual sample where you showcase your skills, style, and experience. It should focus on the specific role you're applying for: sound, music, implementation, etc. Avoid using a generic reel with too much variety if the pieces lack coherence.

It's recommended to keep it between 1 and 1.5 minutes, with three sections of around 20 seconds each. You can include gameplay, cinematic scenes, or other types of interactive content.

If you work in more than one area (e.g., composition and sound design), it's best to have a separate reel for each discipline.

YouTube is the most used platform, though you can also use Vimeo or other alternatives. Ideally, the video should be available online, without download, and should play properly on any device.

CONSIDERATIONS

- Keep a narrative thread that fits the role you're applying for. Avoid mixing very different styles if there's no connection (e.g., kids > war > sci-fi).
- Include text or captions stating your role in each piece (e.g., sound design, music, implementation), project name, and contact info.
- Show full clips or fragments of around 20 seconds. Avoid overly fast cuts or edits with no context.
- Make sure the video is optimized for playback on platforms like YouTube or Vimeo, with no download needed.
- If needed, use subtitles or markers to guide the viewer's attention — use tools from the platform itself.

HEADERS AND SUBTITLES

MARKERS

08 JOB INTERVIEWS

Interviews can cause anxiety, especially if we're not familiar with the process. But it's important to remember that, in the end, it's just a conversation. It doesn't define who you are or your professional worth. The company just wants to get to know you better and see if your profile fits the team and the project.

Usually, the process includes several rounds (in some cases, up to five), and may include technical tests, which are explained later on.

If everything goes well, you'll receive a **job offer**, detailing things like salary, benefits, contract type, and modality. Keep in mind that **everything in the offer can be negotiated**, but only before signing it.

Once signed, any changes depend on the mutual agreement of both parties.

RECOMMENDATIONS

- Research the company before the interview: check their projects, values, team, and whether they offer relocation or special conditions.
- Be honest about your strengths and areas for improvement. Talking with trusted people can help you identify what to highlight in the interview.
- If the interview is in another language, don't worry about making mistakes. What matters most is communicating your ideas. Ask for clarification if needed.
- Remember that no one expects you to be perfect. Many people will be willing to help or guide you during the conversation. They're looking for someone who fits the team, not for a perfect answer.
- Avoid exaggerating or lying about your skills. It's better to explain clearly what you can do than to promise something you can't deliver. Honesty builds long-term trust.

08 JOB INTERVIEWS

TECHNICAL TESTS

During the selection process, it's common for some companies to include a technical test. These are meant to evaluate your practical skills and how you solve situations similar to what you'd face in day-to-day work.

The format and focus of these tests depend on the role:

- **Sound design**: you're usually sent a video between 20 seconds and 2 minutes long to which you'll add effects, ambiences, UI, or foley.
- **Composition**: you might be asked for a music piece based on a scene or a thematic description, sometimes with duration limits or specific style requirements.
- **Implementation**: tests might involve middleware (Wwise, FMOD) or game engines (Unity, Unreal), such as creating events, logic conditions, or basic audio/music integration.
- **Audio programming**: you might be asked to write or review code, fix bugs, or implement simple interactive audio systems.

Instructions should be clear, with a deadline and details about the expected delivery format. If anything is unclear, don't hesitate to ask for clarification. Expressing doubts is part of the process and shows responsibility.

These tests are generally unpaid, though some companies offer a symbolic payment for your time. Evaluate each case based on your availability and level of interest. If a test feels abusive or disproportionate, it's valid to turn it down.

Deadlines are usually 1 to 2 weeks, depending on complexity. Some companies allow extensions if needed, especially if you have other work or personal obligations.

Important: It's frowned upon to publicly share the contents of these tests—and if you signed an NDA, it's illegal. This is because it may compromise the transparency of the process. If you want to practice, look for shared experiences on platforms like Glassdoor or in professional forums. You can also practice on your own or in game jams.

09 NETWORKING

Networking is a key tool for professional growth. Through platforms like LinkedIn or specific communities, you can connect with people in the industry, discover job opportunities, and learn from shared experiences.

It's important to understand that networking doesn't guarantee a job—it simply brings you closer to spaces where opportunities might appear. The people you meet aren't responsible for hiring you, but they can help you grow, share resources, or recommend you if a position aligns with your profile.

LinkedIn is one of the main platforms to build and maintain professional contacts. Following studios, recruiters, artists, and companies in the field can lead to new opportunities. It's also useful to engage with relevant posts, so the algorithm shows content aligned with your interests.

Some recommendations:

- Use your profile as an extended résumé: keep it clear, professional, and include links to your portfolio or demo reel.
- Maintain good etiquette: avoid directly asking for jobs if there's no open position. Instead, show interest in future opportunities or the studio's projects.
- Don't limit yourself to applying. Reach out to studios, comment on their posts, or start conversations with people in your field.
- Join audio and game development communities. Many are active on Discord, forums, or social media.

Remember: no one gets far alone. Building genuine relationships, supporting others, and sharing your journey is a core part of growing in the industry.

10 INCLUSIVE EMPLOYMENT

Entering the job market can be more challenging for individuals from historically marginalized groups. However, the industry is changing, and more and more studios are committed to creating diverse, safe, and inclusive environments.

Groups that tend to face the most barriers include:

- Women and non-binary people.
- LGBTIQ+ community.
- Racialized individuals (Black and Asian movements, especially in the U.S.).
- Neurodivergent people or those with diverse functional conditions.
- Indigenous peoples.
- Latinx community (outside Latin America).
- People experiencing social or economic vulnerability.

Some companies publish specific opportunities for these groups or have internal inclusion policies. These calls may not be very visible, so it's useful to follow their social media or careers sections on their websites.

There are also communities and support groups that offer guidance, resources, opportunities, and spaces to share experiences. Being part of these networks can make a big difference.

You should never feel the need to hide who you are to fit in, **as long as your safety and integrity are protected**. While there are still spaces that exclude or resist change, many others value diversity and mutual respect. Your identity should not limit you—it can empower you and connect you with those who share your values.

Speaking up, sharing, and seeking support not only helps you personally—it also opens doors for those who come after you.

11 FREELANCE WORK STRATEGIES

In recent years, it has become increasingly common to adopt a freelance work model. In this setup, a person takes on multiple temporary contracts and offers their services through platforms like Fiverr, UpWork, or Freelancer. This approach allows for greater autonomy but also requires a clear long-term strategy to remain sustainable.

As audio professionals, our focus should be on offering concrete solutions and clearly communicating our value. In a field as specific as game audio, it's essential to diversify within your **own specialty** to maintain workflow—even when projects come from different sources.

A solid strategy is to choose **one main discipline** and complement it with sub-areas you can handle confidently. For example, if your focus is implementation, you could specialize in integrating audio using middlewares like FMOD or Wwise, add scripting or programming skills, and develop custom tools. If you're into sound design, you might also offer interactive content, trailer production, or audio implementation, among others.

It's also important to consider that the line between the roles of **Sound Designer** and **Technical Sound Designer** has become increasingly blurred in recent years. It's now common for both profiles to share tasks, or for a basic understanding of integration, event logic, or engine work to be expected—even from those with a more creative background.

The clearer and more defined your service range is, the easier it becomes for others to understand how you add value. As you take on more jobs, you can even present yourself as a small studio and expand by working with others, whether hired or in a duo format—while maintaining a consistent professional identity.

It's important to maintain professional visibility. Having an active LinkedIn profile and an updated portfolio helps showcase your work, your services, and your focus. If you plan to share content, be sure to have the client's permission if the material is private or confidential. In the case of tools or plug-ins, there's usually more flexibility, but it's still best to clarify that in a contract.

12 RESOURCES

CV / Writing / Demo Reel

Canva
PDF Compress
Linktree
Youtube
Linkedin

Job Boards / Related

devbrada
Aardvark Swift (possible reloc)
Data Scope (possible reloc)
Gamejobs CO
Sound Lister Newsletter
Remote Game Jobs
Work with Indies
HitMarker
Indeed
GamesJobs Direct

Google Jobs Search Engine
Discord (Servers focused on game and audio development)

Others

Linkedin profile Tips
Game Audio FAQ

13 ABOUT THE AUTHOR

I'm León. I've spent several years working in the audio field within the media and video game industries. Although this discipline often goes unnoticed, it plays a key role in storytelling and user experience.

I've worked in recording studios, television, film, dubbing, and currently, in video games. My path hasn't been linear: I've faced tough times, made difficult decisions, and took on other jobs in parallel to support myself.
I decided to write this guide because I noticed that many people don't know where to start in this industry—especially if Spanish is their native language. I want to share what I've learned, not just on a technical level, but also from a human perspective.

If you're currently going through the job insertion process, know that you're not alone. Everyone working in this field has gone through doubts, frustration, and learning. With effort, support, and a bit of luck, you'll find your place.
Interacting with the community is key. It won't just open doors—it'll also hold you up.

SPECIAL THANKS

I want to thank everyone who, in one way or another, contributed to the creation of this guide. Some supported me professionally, others personally. For privacy reasons, I'll only mention first names or nicknames:

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Rocío, Raúl, Panda, Patito, Nacho, Ciel, Aylu, Tefy, Eze, Marian, Lean, Mati.
Juanma and Lore, Claudia and Neli.

And to every person who ever lent me a hand.

Thank you.

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